

TEACHING

Anyone, anywhere, can learn to restore living soil.



A mentor teaching on working land.

From first curiosity to professional practice. Everyone starts with the Foundation Courses. Where you go next depends on whether you want to grow better yourself, or help others do it.

Foundation Courses

The science of the soil food web, the organisms and their roles, and how biological amendments are made and applied. Online, self-paced, about 150 hours, and required before any Advanced Program.

Advanced Programs

Soil Microscopy, BioComplete™ Compost Production, Biological Liquid Amendments and Field Trial, each with its own mentor. All four together are the full path.

Accelerator Workshops

The Advanced Programs worked through as a group on working land, the whole method applied at once. Held periodically, and hosted with a partner on their land. Dates and places go up on the school site.

Where it leads

All four Advanced Programs together carry the Soil Food Web Consultant title; Soil Microscopy alone, the Lab Technician title. Every program, with its price, is listed at school.soilfoodweb.com



Apply for a scholarship

Scholarships prioritize applicants in under-resourced regions.

sfw.one/brochure-scholarship

COMMUNITY

A global community makes this work outlast any one of us.



A workshop group around a finished compost pile.



Join the free community

Recordings, live discussion and your questions answered. Free, and open to anyone.

sfw.one/brochure-community

Dr. Ingham taught this so it could be passed on, and it was. Soil Regenerators on six continents teach their neighbors, run their own trials, and restore land farm by farm. They trade results, work through problems together and answer each other's questions, which is how a method outlives the person who found it. She gave this movement its science; the community keeps it alive, and there is a way in for anyone.



STUDY



VOLUNTEER



DONATE



HOST



Soil Food Web
Foundation

A 501(c)(3) nonprofit



The soil beneath our farms and forests is alive.

A web of bacteria, fungi, protozoa, nematodes and microarthropods feeds plants, builds soil, stores carbon and cleans water *when it is intact*.

For forty-five years, Dr. Elaine Ingham mapped the Soil Food Web and taught the world to restore it. We carry her legacy forward: showing **what** is possible, teaching **how** to partner with life in the soil, researching **why** things work or do not, and getting dirty through **direct action** on working land. Living soil is the solution, and it is beneath your feet.



EDUCATION



RESEARCH



PRACTICE



COMMUNITY

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Portland, Oregon 97239
soilfoodweb.com

Soil Food Web Foundation is a 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization, EIN 39-4439236. The Soil Food Web School is a program of the Foundation.



Donate

Gifts fund open research, scholarships and field projects. Tax-deductible to the extent allowed by law.

sfw.one/brochure-donate

132+

Countries in our student and practitioner community

10,000+

Individuals enrolled in our programs

45

Years of pioneering soil biology research behind the method

Healing soil.
Feeding humanity.
Restoring the living world.

OUR STORY

It began with one scientist looking closer.



Dr. Elaine Ingham at the microscope.

Dr. Elaine Ingham pioneered research in soil biology across forty-five years and made her science radically accessible, so that anyone anywhere could learn to restore the soil beneath their feet.

The Foundation was created in 2025 to carry that teaching forward. She passed in February 2026, and the work she started continues through the Foundation, the school inside it, and practitioners in more than 132 countries who bring the same close attention to their own soil.

She taught at Oregon State from 1986 to 2002, served as the first President of the Soil Ecology Society, and co-authored the USDA's Soil Biology Primer.



Her published record, in full:
scholar.google.com/citations?user=iOm3z4AAAAAJ



WHY THIS MATTERS FOR CLIMATE

Plants pull carbon from the air and invest much of it in the soil, where it is built into microbial bodies, aggregates and long-lived fungal networks. Biological management also avoids emissions, because less fertilizer has to be made and moved, and the field needs fewer passes.



Watch a free webinar

A live hour with an instructor or a practitioner, every month. The easiest first step.

sfw.one/brochure-webinar

RESEARCH

The science is open, and anyone can test it.



Soil samples beside the microscope.

Forty-five years of soil biology research, practiced by graduates in more than 132 countries on six continents.

What the biology does when it is intact



NUTRIENT
CYCLING



SOIL
STRUCTURE



WEED
PRESSURE



PESTS AND
DISEASE



Testate amoeba, 40x objective. Photograph: Joy Kaluf. A count names what is there: bacteria, fungi, protozoa, nematodes and microarthropods.

What we test before we recommend



Measurable. Every recommendation starts with a count, not a guess.



Diagnostic first. We look at your soil before we suggest anything.



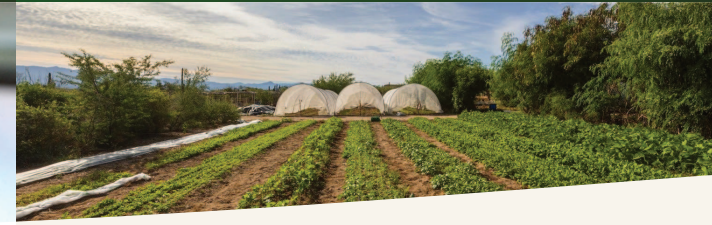
Compatible. No need to tear up what you have.

Each mechanism we teach is established soil biology. How much of any one benefit a field sees depends on climate, crop, starting condition and management. We publish results by site, with the person and the year, and say what one site cannot prove.

Dr. Ingham's publications, item by item, on our publications page:
soilfoodweb.com/publications

PRACTICE

Growers are already doing this, at every scale.



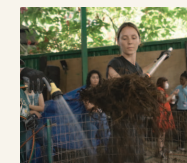
Agroecology plots at Rancho Cacachilas.

The biology is universal; the practice is local. Every result we publish names the grower who got it and the year they did.

Nick Padwick farms four thousand acres in Norfolk, England. Roberto Silva works a hundred and forty in Piura, Peru. Jenn Sirp grows on a quarter acre in California. They film the work themselves and publish what changed, so nobody has to take our word for it.

The scale runs from that quarter acre to ten thousand acres of corn and soy in Illinois, and a public park on Governors Island in New York. The steps are the same at every size: look at the biology under a microscope, add what is missing, and measure again.

We partner with growers to trial the approach where they farm, and to document what happens when they do.



Find a trained professional near you

Consultants and lab technicians who finished the assessed programs are listed in our own directory.



Watch the case studies

Growers filming their own soil, crop by crop and climate by climate. Start with one that looks like yours.

sfw.one/brochure-casestudies